

PULSEGUARD TECHNOLOGIES INC. - STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

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Author: Vikram Singhania (Head of Information Security)
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1. PURPOSE & OBJECTIVE

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the mandatory corporate policies regarding password complexity, credential storage, mandatory Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and account lifecycle management across PulseGuard Technologies Inc. Its primary purpose is to safeguard all corporate accounts, customer data, and infrastructure against credential stuffing, phishing, and unauthorized access.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies globally to ALL employees, contractors, interns, executive staff, and third-party vendors accessing PulseGuard email, Slack, Google Workspace, AWS/Azure/GCP cloud environments, GitHub repositories, and internal SaaS platforms.

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1. All Employees & Contractors

- Must maintain strong, unique passwords for every corporate service.
- Must register approved hardware or software MFA authenticators.
- Must immediately report lost authentication tokens or suspected

compromises.

3.2. IT Security Operations

- Enforces automated password policies and biometric SSO configurations.
- Audits stale corporate accounts and enforces quarterly credential reviews.
- Automatically isolates compromised identities within 5 minutes of detection.

3.3. Department Managers

- Ensures departing team members have access revoked within 2 hours of offboarding.

4. DEFINITIONS AND REFERENCES

- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Security mechanism requiring two or more independent verification factors (e.g., password + TOTP authenticator app / WebAuthn).
- Password Manager: Company-approved enterprise vault (e.g., 1Password, Bitwarden).
- Privileged Access Management (PAM): Special controls for root and admin accounts.
- Reference: SOP-ENG-002 (Security Incident Response Protocol).

5. PASSWORD COMPLEXITY AND LIFECYCLE RULES

5.1. Minimum Complexity Standards

- Passwords must be at least 16 characters in length.
- Must contain at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character (!@#\$%^&*()_+=[{}]|;:,.<>?).
- Common dictionary words, sequential numbers, and personal details (e.g. birth dates,

company name) are strictly forbidden and rejected by automated IAM gates.

5.2. Mandatory Password Managers

- All employees must generate and store credentials in the company-provided enterprise password manager.
- Storing passwords in plain text, spreadsheets, sticky notes, or private browsers is a direct compliance violation.

5.3. Credential Rotation

- Human user passwords do not expire automatically unless suspected of compromise.
- Service account tokens, API secret keys, and database administrative passwords must be rotated every 90 days.

6. MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA) MANDATE

6.1. Approved Factors

- Hardware security keys (FIDO2 / YubiKey) and Mobile Authenticator Apps (Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator) are mandatory.
- SMS-based (text message) verification is explicitly PROHIBITED due to SIM-swapping risks.

6.2. Mandatory Universal Coverage

- MFA must be enabled on 100% of corporate accounts without exception.
- Bypassing or requesting exemptions for MFA requires written VP authorization.

7. COMPLIANCE VIOLATIONS & INCIDENT REPORTING

7.1. Immediate Notification

- If an employee enters corporate credentials into a phishing link or loses an MFA device, they must notify security-ops@policypulse.dev within 15 minutes.

7.2. Disciplinary Actions

- Intentional credential sharing or disabling security controls will lead to immediate account suspension and formal disciplinary review.

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